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Here is the complete, fully written textbook chapter:

UNIT 8: Ethical, Social, and Legal Concerns in Computer Usage

"The internet is not just a tool. It is a place where people live. And like any place where people live, it has rules, responsibilities, and consequences."

A Note to the Student

Welcome. Before we begin, let's make one thing clear: **you are not just a computer user. You are a digital citizen.**

A citizen has rights. A citizen also has responsibilities. In this chapter, you will learn both. You will discover how to stay safe online, how to treat others with respect in digital spaces, and how to understand the laws that protect ideas and creations.

Some of this might sound serious. It is. But it is also empowering. Every concept in this chapter is a skill — a super-power that makes you smarter, safer, and more responsible in the digital world.

Let's get started.

Introduction

Story Mode: The Day Sara Lost Everything

Sara is a 9th-grade student. She is hardworking and loves writing stories. One day, she spent three weeks writing her best story ever on her school laptop. She did not back it up. She used the same password — **sara123** — for everything. She shared her school email password with her best friend "just for a second."

Then one day: the laptop crashed. The story was gone. Her email was hacked. Someone posted embarrassing things from her account. Her school project was copied and uploaded online without her name on it.

Sara felt helpless. She didn't know it could happen so fast.

The truth? Every single problem Sara faced was preventable. And by the end of this chapter, **you will know exactly how to prevent all of them.**

What Is This Chapter About?

Computers are powerful tools. But power without responsibility causes problems. This chapter teaches you three big things:

1. **How to use computers safely** — protecting your data, your accounts, and your devices.
2. **How to behave responsibly online** — respecting others, protecting privacy, and avoiding scams.
3. **How to understand digital laws** — what you are legally allowed to do with software, music, images, and ideas that belong to others.

Plain-Language Summary: This chapter teaches you to be smart, safe, and honest in the digital world.

8.1 Secure Computer Usage

Story Mode: The Unlocked Door

Imagine you live in a house. Every night before sleeping, you lock the front door. You would never go to bed leaving the door wide open, because anyone could walk in.

Your computer is like a house. Your files, photos, passwords, and personal information live inside. **If you don't "lock" your computer properly, strangers can walk in and take everything.**

Secure computer usage means locking every digital door — so your information stays yours.

What Does "Secure Computer Usage" Mean?

Secure computer usage means using your computer in a way that protects you from harm. This includes:

- Protecting your personal information (name, address, phone number, passwords).
- Making smart choices about which hardware and software to use.
- Making sure your online activities do not hurt you or anyone else.

Let's break this down into three parts.

Part 1: Choosing the Right Hardware and Software

Hardware = the physical parts of a computer. Examples: keyboard, monitor, CPU, mouse.

Software = the programs you run on a computer. Examples: Microsoft Word, a game, an antivirus program.

Choosing the right hardware and software matters for three reasons:

Safety

Outdated software has weaknesses. Hackers know how to attack old software. Always use updated, trusted software. For example, using a computer without updated **antivirus software** is like leaving your door open. Antivirus software is a program that finds and removes harmful programs (called **viruses** or **malware**) from your computer.

Efficiency

The right hardware makes your work smooth and fast. Imagine trying to run a modern video game on a computer that is 15 years old — it won't work. Good hardware means your tasks are completed quickly and easily.

Compatibility

Compatibility means that your hardware and software are designed to work together. Before buying or installing new software, always check the **system requirements** — the minimum hardware your computer needs to run the software properly. For example, if a game requires 8 GB of RAM and your computer only has 4 GB, the game will not run.

Visual Tip — Draw This!

Draw a triangle. Label the three corners: **Safety**, **Efficiency**, **Compatibility**. In the middle, write: **Good Computer Usage**. This triangle shows that all three must be balanced.

Part 2: Protecting Your Personal Information

Personal information is any data that can identify you. Examples:

- Your full name
- Your home address
- Your phone number
- Your date of birth
- Your passwords

Why protect it? Because if the wrong person gets your personal information, they can steal your identity, access your accounts, or even harm you physically.

Practical Walkthrough: How to Protect Your Personal Information

1. **Never share your passwords** with anyone — not even your best friend.
2. **Log out of accounts** after using a shared computer (school lab, library).
3. **Do not fill out forms** on websites unless you are 100% sure the website is trusted.
4. **Check for HTTPS** in the web address. HTTPS means the website is secure. HTTP (without the "S") is not secure. The "S" stands for **Secure**.
5. **Think before you type**. Ask yourself: "Would I be comfortable if everyone could see this?" If not, don't type it online.

Quick Recap: Secure computer usage means choosing safe hardware and software, keeping your personal data private, and always being aware of the risks around you.

Interactive Stop-Point: The Security Audit

Look at the list below. For each item, write **SAFE** or **UNSAFE** in your notebook:

Action	Your Answer
Using the same password for your email and your game account	
Logging out of your school portal after using a shared computer	
Using antivirus software that was last updated three years ago	
Checking for HTTPS before entering your address on a website	
Sharing your home address in a public social media post	

(Answers: Unsafe, Safe, Unsafe, Safe, Unsafe)

8.2 Responsible Computer Usage

Story Mode: Ahmed and the Fake Email

Ahmed received an email. It said:

"Dear Ahmed, your bank account has been locked. Click here immediately to unlock it. Enter your full name, date of birth, and account password."

Ahmed was nervous. He clicked the link. The website looked real. He entered his information.

Three days later, his family's bank account was emptied.

What happened? Ahmed was the victim of a **phishing scam** — a fake message designed to trick you into giving away personal information.

The lesson? Responsible computer usage means knowing how tricks like this work — and never falling for them.

What Is Responsible Computer Usage?

Being responsible means making **thoughtful, careful decisions** every time you use a computer. This includes:

- Using secure digital platforms
 - Creating strong passwords
 - Protecting your accounts with extra layers of security
 - Recognizing and avoiding scams
 - Backing up your important data
-

Use of Secure Digital Platforms

A **digital platform** is any online service you use — social media, email, online banking, school portals, gaming accounts. Using these platforms **securely** requires six key habits.

Habit 1: Using Strong Passwords

A **password** is the key to your digital house. A weak password is a broken key — anyone can copy it.

What makes a password strong?

A strong password has ALL of the following:

- At least **8 characters** (longer is better — aim for 12+)
- A mix of **uppercase and lowercase letters** (A, b, C)
- At least one **number** (3, 7, 9)
- At least one **special character** (!@#\$%^&*)

Example:

Weak Password	Strong Password
ahmed123	Ahn3d!sMy\$T@r
password	P@\$w0rd#2024
sara	S@r@L0v3sC0d3!

Visual Tip — The Password Strength Gauge:

Imagine a fuel gauge in a car. On the far left it says **EMPTY (Weak)** and on the far right it says **FULL (Strong)**. The needle moves right as you add length, numbers, uppercase letters, and special characters. A password like **ahmed** sits near EMPTY. A password like **Ahn3d!sMy\$T@r** sits near FULL.

Practical Walkthrough: Creating a Strong Password

1. Think of a short sentence you will remember. Example: *"I love Computer Science in 2024!"*
2. Take the first letter of each word: **ILCS2024**
3. Replace some letters with numbers or symbols: **!LCS#2024**
4. Add an uppercase and a special character at the end: **!LCS#2024@**
5. **Result:** **!LCS#2024@** — This is a strong, memorable password.

Never use: your name, birthday, phone number, or the word "password" as your password.

Habit 2: Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

Even a strong password can sometimes be stolen. **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** adds a second lock to your account.

2FA means: After you enter your password, the system asks you to prove your identity a **second time** — usually by sending a code to your phone number.

Think of it like this: Your school locker has a combination lock AND a key. Even if someone knows the combination, they still need the key to open it. **2FA is the second key.**

How 2FA Works — Step by Step:

1. You go to a website (e.g., your email).
2. You type your **username** and **password**.
3. The system sends a **6-digit code** to your registered phone number via SMS.
4. You enter the code on the website.

5. Only then are you allowed inside.

Why is this powerful? Even if a hacker steals your password, they cannot log in without your phone. They have your key, but not your lock.

Always enable 2FA on important accounts: email, school portal, social media.

Habit 3: Avoiding Public Wi-Fi for Sensitive Transactions

Public Wi-Fi is internet available for everyone in a public place — like a café, airport, or library. It sounds convenient. But it is dangerous for sensitive activities.

Why? Public Wi-Fi is often **not encrypted**. Encryption means your data is scrambled so others cannot read it. On a public Wi-Fi network without encryption, other people on the same network can sometimes **see what you are typing** — including passwords and bank details.

The Rule: Never do these things on public Wi-Fi:

- Online banking
- Entering passwords
- Shopping with your credit/debit card
- Accessing medical or personal records

What IS safe on public Wi-Fi?

- Reading news
- Watching YouTube videos
- General browsing (not entering any personal data)

Visual Tip — The Danger Zone:

Draw a circle. Inside it, write "HOME Wi-Fi = SAFE." Outside the circle, write "PUBLIC Wi-Fi = DANGER ZONE for sensitive tasks." This shows the boundary clearly.

Habit 4: Being Aware of Scams and Phishing

Phishing is when a criminal sends a fake message pretending to be a real company — to trick you into giving your personal information.

The word "phishing" sounds like "fishing." The criminal is **fishing for your information** using a fake bait (the fake message).

How to Spot a Phishing Message:

Warning Sign	Example
Urgent, scary language	"Your account will be deleted in 24 hours!"
Asks for your password	"Enter your password to verify your account"
Sender email looks fake	<code>support@bank-secure-login.com</code> instead of <code>support@bank.com</code>
Links go to strange websites	Hovering over a link shows an unrelated URL
Grammar and spelling errors	"Pleese click hear to verify you're account"

Practical Walkthrough: What to Do When You Receive a Suspicious Message

1. **Do NOT click** any links in the message.
2. **Do NOT reply** to the message.
3. **Check the sender's email address** carefully. Is it the real company's address?
4. **Go directly** to the company's website by typing the address yourself.
5. **Report the message** as spam or phishing in your email app.
6. **Delete the message.**

Golden Rule: A real bank, school, or company will **never** ask for your password via email or SMS.

Habit 5: Regularly Reviewing Your Account Activity

This means checking your accounts regularly to spot anything unusual.

What to look for:

- Logins from cities or countries you have never visited
- Emails or messages you did not send
- Purchases or transactions you did not make
- Password changes you did not request

What to do if you spot something suspicious:

1. **Change your password immediately.**
2. **Enable 2FA** if you haven't already.
3. **Log out of all devices** (most platforms have a "Log out of all sessions" option in settings).
4. **Report the suspicious activity** to the platform's support team.

Habit 6: Backing Up Important Data

Backing up means saving a copy of your important files in a second, safe location.

Think about it this way: you write a 10-page project. Your laptop breaks. Without a backup, your project is gone forever. With a backup, you simply open the second copy.

Where to Back Up Your Data:

Method	What It Is	Example
External Hard Drive	A physical device you plug into your computer	Store a copy of your files on a USB drive or portable hard disk
Cloud Storage	Online storage service	Google Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive

How Often Should You Back Up?

- School projects: after every major editing session
- Important documents: at least once a week
- Photos: at least once a month

Quick Recap: Responsible computer usage means using strong passwords, enabling 2FA, avoiding public Wi-Fi for sensitive tasks, recognizing phishing scams, checking your account activity, and backing up your data regularly.

Interactive Stop-Point: Real or Fake?

Read the two messages below. Decide: Is this **PHISHING** or **REAL**? Explain your reasoning to a partner.

Message A:

"Hi! This is your school library. Your library card renewal is now available. Visit our website at www.schoollibrary.edu.pk to renew. No password required."

Message B:

"URGENT!!! Your FACEBOOK account has been LOCKED!!! Click [HERE](#) immediately to unlock: www.fb-secure-login-pk.net. Enter your email and password NOW or your account will be permanently deleted in 2 hours."

(Message A is likely real. Message B is phishing — it uses urgency, a fake URL, and asks for your password.)

8.3 Best Practices in Online Behavior

Story Mode: The Post That Could Not Be Deleted

Usman was angry one evening. A classmate had teased him at school. So Usman went home, opened Instagram, and posted a very unkind comment about his classmate — with his classmate's full name and photo.

The next morning, the post had been shared 47 times. Teachers saw it. Parents saw it. The principal called Usman's parents.

Usman deleted the post. But by then, screenshots existed everywhere. It could never truly be gone.

The lesson? Online, your words travel faster than you think — and they can stay forever, even after you delete them. Responsible online behavior means thinking before you act.

Using Digital Platforms Responsibly

You use digital platforms every day. Let's look at the most common ones and the rules for using each safely.

Social Media (Facebook, Instagram, Snapchat, TikTok)

Social media connects you with friends and the world. But it also exposes you to risks if used carelessly.

Rules for Responsible Social Media Use:

- **Never share personal information publicly.** This includes: your home address, school name, daily schedule, phone number, or photos of your location.
- **Think before you post.** Ask: *"Would I be okay if my parents, my teacher, or a stranger saw this?"* If no — don't post it.
- **Check your privacy settings.** Set your account to "Private" so only approved followers can see your posts.
- **Don't accept friend requests from strangers.** You don't know who they really are.
- **Report and block** accounts that make you feel uncomfortable.

Practical Walkthrough: Setting Your Instagram Account to Private

1. Open the Instagram app and tap your **profile icon** (bottom right).
2. Tap the **three lines** (menu) at the top right.
3. Tap **Settings and Privacy**.
4. Tap **Account Privacy**.
5. Toggle on **Private Account**.
6. Tap **Switch to Private** to confirm.

Now only people you approve can see your posts.

Email

Email is used for school, job applications, and formal communication. It is powerful — and risky if misused.

Rules for Responsible Email Use:

- **Never open emails from unknown senders.** Especially if they have attachments or links.
 - **Never click links** inside suspicious emails. Instead, go directly to the website by typing its address.
 - **Never share your password** via email — not even with someone claiming to be your school's IT department.
 - **Use a professional tone** when emailing teachers or officials. Write clearly and politely.
 - **Check the sender's email address** before replying.
-

Cloud Services (Google Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive)

Cloud services let you store and share files online. They are incredibly useful for school projects and group work.

Rules for Safe Cloud Service Use:

- **Use strong passwords** for your cloud accounts.
 - **Never upload sensitive documents** (like national ID scans, financial records) unless absolutely necessary.
 - **Share files carefully.** When sharing a document, choose "View only" unless you want others to edit it.
 - **Log out** of cloud services on shared or public computers.
 - **Never store your passwords in a cloud file.** If your account is hacked, all passwords are exposed.
-

Online Applications (Games, Shopping, Learning Apps)

Online apps are fun and useful. But not all apps are safe.

Rules for Safe App Use:

- **Download apps only from official stores:** Google Play Store or Apple App Store.
 - **Read app permissions carefully.** If a flashlight app asks to access your contacts and camera — that is suspicious.
 - **Don't make in-app purchases** without a parent's permission.
 - **Read reviews** before downloading an unknown app.
 - **Uninstall apps** you no longer use.
-

Privacy Settings and Data Security

Privacy settings are controls inside apps and websites that let you decide who can see your information, who can contact you, and what data is collected about you.

Visual Tip — The Privacy Control Panel:

Imagine a control panel with switches and sliders. Each switch controls one part of your privacy:

- Switch 1: Who can see my profile? (*Public / Friends only / Only me*)
- Switch 2: Who can send me messages? (*Everyone / Friends only / No one*)
- Switch 3: Who can see my location? (*On / Off*)
- Switch 4: Who can tag me in photos? (*Everyone / Friends / No one*)

Your job is to set each switch to the safest position that still lets you enjoy the platform.

Data Security means protecting the data that platforms collect about you.

Every app and website collects some data about you — your name, location, browsing habits, clicks. This is called **data collection**. Sometimes companies use this data to show you advertisements. Sometimes they share it with other companies.

How to Protect Your Data:

1. Read the **Privacy Policy** of any app before signing up (at least the summary).
 2. Choose apps from companies that have a clear, understandable privacy policy.
 3. Regularly **review which apps have access** to your phone's camera, microphone, and location. Remove access you don't need.
 4. Use a **different email address** for non-important apps, so your main email stays clean.
-

Quick Recap: Best practices in online behavior mean using every digital platform thoughtfully — protecting your information, respecting others, and understanding who can see what you post or share.

Interactive Stop-Point: The Digital Decision Maker

For each situation below, choose the **best action**. Discuss your choice with a partner and explain why.

Situation 1: You receive a message on WhatsApp from an unknown number. It says: *"I know your school. I have your photo. Reply to this number or I will post it online."*

- A) Reply immediately and ask who they are.
- B) Block the number, screenshot the message, and tell a trusted adult immediately.
- C) Ignore it and hope it goes away.

Situation 2: Your friend shares a Google Drive link with a folder full of movies. She says you can download them for free. These are movies you normally have to pay for.

- A) Download them — it's free!
- B) Ask your friend if these are legally shared.
- C) Do not download them, because free downloads of paid movies are likely illegal (piracy).

(Best answers: 1-B, 2-C)

8.4 Intellectual Property Rights

Story Mode: The Invisible Thief

Bilal spent four months drawing a comic book. He posted the first page on his school's online gallery. Three weeks later, his friend showed him a website selling printed copies of his comic — with someone else's name on it.

Bilal's work had been stolen. But not his physical drawing. The thief had stolen something invisible — his **idea**, his **creation**, his **intellectual work**.

This is called **intellectual property theft** — and it is just as serious as stealing a physical object.

What Is Intellectual Property?

Intellectual property (IP) is any creation of the mind. This includes:

- Books, articles, and stories
- Music and songs
- Software and apps
- Paintings, drawings, and photographs
- Inventions and new processes
- Company logos and brand names

Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) are the legal rules that protect these creations. They give creators control over how their work is used by others.

There are three main types: **Copyright**, **Trademark**, and **Patent**.

Copyright ©

Copyright is a legal right that gives a creator full control over their original work.

When you write a story, draw a picture, compose a song, or write a computer program — **you automatically own the copyright**. No one can copy, share, sell, or modify your work without your permission.

What Does Copyright Protect?

- Books and written content
- Music and audio recordings
- Movies and videos
- Photographs
- Software code
- Paintings and drawings

How Long Does Copyright Last?

In most countries, copyright lasts for the **lifetime of the creator plus 70 years**. After that, the work becomes "public domain" — free for anyone to use.

Example:

When an author writes a novel, she owns the copyright. If a student copies chapters of that novel and distributes them in class without permission — that is a **copyright violation**, even if no money is involved.

What About Digital Content?

The same rules apply online. You cannot:

- Copy and paste someone's article into your own blog without credit.
- Download and share a movie without the creator's permission.
- Upload a song to a video without a music license.

Copyright Symbol: ©. When you see this symbol next to a work, it means the creator has legal protection over it.

Trademark [™] / ®

A **trademark** is a symbol, word, phrase, logo, or design that identifies and distinguishes a company's products or services from others.

Examples of Famous Trademarks:

- The Nike "swoosh" ✓
- The McDonald's golden arches M
- The Apple logo
- Coca-Cola's unique font and bottle shape

Why Do Trademarks Matter?

They prevent other companies from using similar logos or names to confuse customers. If you started a shoe company and used the Nike swoosh — you would be violating Nike's trademark.

Symbols:

- [™] = The company claims the trademark but it may not yet be legally registered.
 - ® = The trademark is officially registered and has full legal protection.
-

Patent

A **patent** protects a **new invention or process**. It gives the inventor the **exclusive right** to make, use, or sell the invention for a certain period of time (usually **20 years**).

Examples:

- Alexander Graham Bell patented the first telephone.
- A company that invents a new type of battery can patent it — no other company can copy that battery design for 20 years without permission.

Why Patents Matter:

They reward inventors for their hard work. If anyone could copy your invention the moment you released it, nobody would bother inventing new things.

Visual Tip — The IP Triangle:

Draw a triangle. Label the three corners:

- **Copyright** (creative works — books, music, software)
- **Trademark** (brand identity — logos, names)
- **Patent** (inventions — new products, processes)

In the middle, write: **Intellectual Property Rights**

This triangle covers everything that "belongs" to a creator's mind.

Ethical and Legal Responsibilities Regarding Intellectual Property Rights

Knowing that IP rights exist is not enough. You must also **behave ethically** — meaning doing the right thing, even when no one is watching.

Software Piracy

Software piracy means using, copying, or distributing software without buying a legal license.

Examples of Software Piracy:

- Downloading a paid app from an unofficial website for free
- Copying a licensed program from one computer to 10 computers using one license
- Using a "cracked" version of software (a version where the payment system has been hacked)

Why Is Piracy Harmful?

- It is **illegal**. You can face fines or legal action.
- It **harms creators**. Software developers work hard to create programs. Piracy means they don't get paid for their work.
- Pirated software often contains **malware** — harmful programs hidden inside the fake free software.

Plagiarism

Plagiarism means using someone else's words or ideas as if they were your own — without giving them credit.

In school: copying from a classmate's essay.

Online: copying text from a website into your report without citing the source.

Plagiarism is:

- **Ethically wrong** — you're taking credit for someone else's hard work.
- **Academically harmful** — teachers can detect it, and consequences are serious.
- **Legally risky** — if the copied work is copyrighted, plagiarism can be a legal violation.

How to Avoid Plagiarism:

1. Always write ideas in **your own words**.
2. If you use someone else's words, use **quotation marks** and name the source.
3. At the end of your report, include a **list of sources** you used.

Legal Compliance in Computing

Legal compliance in computing means following the laws related to computers, software, data, and the internet.

Key laws that affect computer users:

Legal Concept	What It Means	Example
Copyright Law	You cannot copy or share creative works without permission	Don't copy-paste an article into your own blog without credit
Software License Agreement	When you install software, you agree to use it only as specified	One license = one computer, unless the license says otherwise
Data Privacy Laws	Organizations must protect the personal data of users	A school cannot share students' personal information without permission
Cybercrime Laws	Hacking, online fraud, and cyberbullying are illegal	Sending fake messages to steal someone's password is a crime

In Pakistan: The **Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act (PECA) 2016** is the main cybercrime law. It covers online harassment, hacking, identity theft, and spreading false information digitally.

Quick Recap: Intellectual property rights protect creative works (copyright), brand identities (trademark), and inventions (patent). Using others' work without permission is both unethical and illegal.

Interactive Stop-Point: Legal, Ethical, or Neither?

Sort each action below into one of three categories: **Legal & Ethical** | **Illegal** | **Unethical but possibly not illegal**

Action	Your Category
Downloading a movie from a free, unofficial website	
Copying a paragraph from Wikipedia into your essay without mentioning the source	
Buying a licensed antivirus program and installing it on your own computer	
Writing a song and registering its copyright	
Using your friend's Netflix account without her knowledge	
Creating a logo that looks almost identical to a famous brand's logo	

(Suggested answers: , , , , ,)

Social Networking Safety and Online Interactions

Privacy Settings, Responsible Sharing, and Online Etiquette

Story Mode: The Accidental Overshare

Hira was excited. She had just been accepted into a school competition. She posted on Facebook: *"So happy!!! Going to Lahore on Saturday for the Science Olympiad at [School Name]. Leaving at 8AM, back by 6PM! House will be empty lol"*

She thought it was harmless. But without realizing it, she had just told the entire internet: when she would be away, where she lived (her school district was public on her profile), and that her house would be empty.

Hira meant no harm. But **oversharing** — sharing too much personal information online — can have serious consequences.

Privacy Settings: Your First Line of Defense

Every social media platform has **privacy settings** — controls that let you decide who sees your content.

Why Are Privacy Settings Important?

By default, many platforms set your account to **Public**, meaning strangers can see everything you post. Changing your settings to **Private** means only approved followers/friends can see your content.

Key Privacy Settings to Check on Any Platform:

Setting	What to Set It To
Who can see my posts?	Friends / Followers only
Who can send me messages?	Friends only
Who can see my friend/follower list?	Only me / Friends only
Who can find me by phone number or email?	Nobody
Location sharing	OFF (unless needed for a specific app like Maps)
Who can tag me in photos?	Only me to approve tags

Responsible Sharing

Responsible sharing means thinking carefully before you post, share, or send anything online.

Before you post, ask yourself these three questions:

1. **Is it true?** Don't share news, rumors, or information you haven't verified.
2. **Is it kind?** Would this hurt or embarrass someone?
3. **Is it necessary?** Does this need to be online? Is sharing this safe?

If the answer to any of these is "No" or "I'm not sure" — **don't post it.**

What NOT to Share Online:

- Your home address or daily routine
- Photos that show your location (street signs, school name, landmarks)
- Personal documents (ID cards, school cards, passport)
- Angry or hateful comments about people
- Other people's private photos or messages without their permission

Online Etiquette

Online etiquette (also called **netiquette**) is the set of rules for respectful, polite behavior online.

Think of it this way: you have manners in real life — you say please and thank you, you don't shout at people, you don't interrupt. **Online etiquette is the same thing, applied to the digital world.**

Core Rules of Online Etiquette:

- **Use respectful language.** Even when you disagree, stay polite.
- **Don't type in ALL CAPS.** Online, all caps means you are SHOUTING.
- **Think before you comment.** Ask: "Would I say this to this person's face in school?"

- **Don't spread rumors or unverified information.**
- **Give credit.** If you share someone's photo or art, name them as the creator.
- **Be patient.** Not everyone replies instantly.
- **Don't spam.** Sending repeated messages is annoying and disrespectful.

The Golden Rule of the Internet: Treat others online exactly as you would like to be treated offline.

Addressing Cyberbullying, Harassment, and Respectful Online Interaction

Story Mode: The Anonymous Bully

Omar thought being anonymous online meant he could say anything. He created a fake account and spent weeks leaving cruel comments on a classmate's social media posts. He thought it was funny. His classmate, Zara, started skipping school. She stopped sleeping well. She cried every day.

One day, the school's cybercrime awareness officer traced the account. Omar was identified. His parents were called. He faced serious disciplinary action.

Omar learned a painful lesson: **There is no true anonymity online. And cruelty — whether online or offline — has real consequences for real people.**

What Is Cyberbullying?

Cyberbullying is when someone uses digital technology — phones, social media, online games, messaging apps — to repeatedly harass, threaten, embarrass, or harm another person.

Forms of Cyberbullying:

Type	Description	Example
Harassment	Sending mean, hurtful messages repeatedly	Constant cruel DMs targeting one person
Exclusion	Deliberately leaving someone out of online groups	Removing a person from a WhatsApp group publicly
Impersonation	Creating a fake account pretending to be someone	Making a fake Instagram account with someone's photos
Cyberstalking	Tracking and monitoring someone online without consent	Following someone's every post and commenting threats
Outing	Sharing someone's private information or photos publicly	Posting someone's private messages to embarrass them

What to Do If You Are Being Cyberbullied

Step 1: Don't Respond.

Responding often makes things worse. The bully wants a reaction. Don't give them one.

Step 2: Document the Evidence.

Take screenshots of all bullying messages, comments, or posts. Save them. You will need them when reporting.

Step 3: Block the Bully.

On every platform:

- Instagram: Go to the person's profile → tap the three dots (⋮) → tap **Block**.
- Facebook: Go to their profile → click the three dots → click **Block**.
- WhatsApp: Open the chat → tap the three dots → **More** → **Block**.

Step 4: Report the Bullying to the Platform.

All major platforms have reporting tools. Use them. The platform can investigate and remove the bully's account.

Step 5: Tell a Trusted Adult.

Tell a parent, teacher, or school counselor. You do not have to face this alone. In Pakistan, cyberbullying can be reported to the **FIA Cybercrime Wing** (Federal Investigation Agency).

Step 6: Take Care of Yourself.

Being bullied online is painful. Talk to someone you trust. Remember: the bully's words say everything about them and nothing about your worth.

What to Do If You SEE Cyberbullying Happening to Someone Else

You are not powerless. You are a bystander — and bystanders have the power to stop bullying.

Your actions as a bystander:

1. **Do NOT share, like, or comment** on bullying content. Doing so amplifies the harm.
2. **Reach out to the person being bullied** privately. A simple message — *"I see what's happening. That's not okay. I'm here for you"* — can make a huge difference.
3. **Report the content** to the platform using the report button.
4. **Tell a trusted adult** — a teacher, a parent, or a school counselor.

Remember: Staying silent when you see bullying is a choice — and it is a choice to let it continue. You have the power to be part of the solution.

Respectful Online Interaction: Building Positive Digital Communities

Being a responsible digital citizen is not just about avoiding bad behavior. It is about **actively creating a positive online environment**.

How to be a positive force online:

- **Lift others up.** Leave encouraging comments on people's work.
- **Share knowledge generously.** If you know something helpful, share it — with credit.
- **Correct mistakes kindly.** If someone shares wrong information, correct them politely — not with mockery.
- **Celebrate diversity.** People from different backgrounds, cultures, and viewpoints make the internet richer. Embrace that.
- **Protect others' privacy.** Never share someone else's personal information or photos without their clear permission.

Quick Recap: Online safety means setting strong privacy controls, sharing only what is necessary and appropriate, treating others with respect, responding to cyberbullying firmly and safely, and actively helping to build positive digital communities.

Final Interactive Stop-Point: The Digital Citizen Pledge

Read the following pledge. Sign it (write your name) in your notebook. Discuss with your class what each line means:

My Digital Citizen Pledge

I, _____, pledge to:

1. **Protect** my personal information and the information of others online.
 2. **Create** strong passwords and use 2FA to keep my accounts secure.
 3. **Think** before I post, share, or comment — asking if it is true, kind, and necessary.
 4. **Respect** the intellectual property of creators by never copying, pirating, or plagiarizing their work.
 5. **Stand up** against cyberbullying — as a target, bystander, or supporter.
 6. **Follow** the law and ethical standards in everything I do online.
 7. **Use** technology to learn, connect, and create — responsibly and with integrity.
-

Chapter Summary

Topic	One-Sentence Takeaway
8.1 Secure Computer Usage	Choose safe hardware and software, and always protect your personal information.
8.2 Responsible Computer Usage	Use strong passwords, 2FA, avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive tasks, recognize scams, and back up your data.
8.3 Best Practices in Online Behavior	Use every digital platform thoughtfully — protect your data, respect privacy settings, and behave ethically.
8.4 Intellectual Property Rights	Copyright, trademark, and patent protect creators' work — respect these rights by never pirating, copying, or plagiarizing.
Social Networking Safety	Set your accounts to private, share responsibly, and follow online etiquette.
Cyberbullying	Report it, block the bully, document evidence, and always tell a trusted adult.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Why is it important to use computers safely and responsibly?

- a) To ensure we can use them more frequently
 - b) To protect our personal information and make wise choices about hardware and software**
 - c) To make the computer run faster
 - d) To avoid paying for software
-

2. What does "responsible computer usage" include?

- a) Choosing the most expensive hardware
 - b) Sharing your passwords with friends
 - c) Being cautious about what you share online and protecting yourself and others**
 - d) Ignoring software updates
-

3. What should you check to ensure hardware and software compatibility?

- a) The color of the hardware
 - b) The system requirements on software packages and match them with your computer's specifications**
 - c) The price of the hardware
 - d) The brand of the hardware
-

4. Why is it important to use strong, unique passwords?

- a) To make your accounts easy to hack
 - b) To help others guess your password
 - c) To make it harder for someone to guess your password and access your accounts**
 - d) To avoid installing software updates
-

5. What is one reason to avoid clicking on unknown links or downloading files from untrusted sources?

- a) They might contain helpful software
 - b) They might contain malware that can harm your device or steal your information**
 - c) They are usually cheaper
 - d) They help your device run faster
-

6. What does Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) do?

- a) It makes your password easier to guess
 - b) It adds an extra layer of security by requiring a second form of verification**
 - c) It removes the need for a password
 - d) It reduces the need for software updates
-

7. Why should you be cautious when using public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions?

- a) Public Wi-Fi is usually faster
 - b) Public Wi-Fi networks are often less secure**
 - c) Public Wi-Fi is free
 - d) Public Wi-Fi always provides encryption
-

8. What is an important aspect of responsible use of social media?

- a) Sharing personal information like your home address
 - b) Posting photos without considering privacy settings
 - c) Being respectful and avoiding sharing sensitive information publicly**
 - d) Ignoring privacy settings
-

9. What should you do if you receive an email from an unknown sender asking for personal information?

- a) Provide the information requested
 - b) Forward the email to your friends
 - c) Ignore or delete the email**
 - d) Open the email and click on any links
-

Short Questions

1. What is the importance of using computers safely and responsibly?
2. Why should you create strong, unique passwords for your accounts?
3. How can you protect yourself from harmful links and downloads?
4. What is Two-Factor Authentication (2FA), and why is it useful?
5. Why is it a good idea to avoid using public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions?
6. Why is it important to be careful about what you share on social media?
7. What is the purpose of privacy laws regarding your personal information?
8. What is software piracy, and why is it harmful?

9. Define copyright and give one example of how it protects a creator.
 10. What is the difference between a trademark and a patent?
 11. What is cyberbullying? List three forms it can take.
 12. What steps should you take if you are being cyberbullied?
 13. What is plagiarism and how can you avoid it?
 14. What are privacy settings and why are they important?
 15. What is "netiquette" and why does it matter?
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You made it through Unit 8. You are now not just a computer user — you are a responsible, informed, and empowered digital citizen. Go protect yourself, help others, and make the internet a better place.